Since **incubation programs** primarily target **idea-stage, validation-stage, and early startup-stage** entrepreneurs, the onboarding should not only collect information but also diagnose the startup's readiness and automatically personalize the incubation journey.

Instead of a single long application form, think of it as a **guided entrepreneur assessment**.

Section 1: Business Stage Assessment (Dynamic Onboarding)

Purpose

This section identifies where the entrepreneur is in their business journey. Based on the selected stage, the platform personalizes the application, learning pathway, assessments, required documents, and mentor recommendations.

Business Stage Selection

The applicant selects one of the following:

- Idea Stage
- Validation Stage
- Prototype / MVP Stage
- Early Startup Stage

Stage Descriptions

Display a short explanation for each stage so applicants can choose accurately.

For example:

Idea Stage

- You have identified a problem and have an idea for a solution, but you have not yet developed a product or started serving customers.

Validation Stage

- You are testing your idea with potential customers and gathering evidence that there is demand.

Prototype / MVP Stage

- You have developed a prototype or Minimum Viable Product (MVP) and are testing it with users.

Early Startup Stage

- Your product or service has launched, you have your first customers, and you are beginning to generate revenue.

Dynamic Stage-Specific Requirements

Once a stage is selected, the platform should display:

- Required information
- Required documents
- Required assessments
- Recommended learning modules
- Suggested mentor expertise
- Milestones expected during incubation

Stage-Specific Information Display

If "Idea Stage" is Selected

Information Required

- Business idea title
- Problem statement
- Proposed solution
- Target customers
- Why this idea matters
- Founder motivation

Suggested Uploads

- Concept note
- Idea sketch
- Research notes (optional)

Assessments

- Entrepreneurial readiness
- Innovation potential
- Problem definition

Recommended Learning

- Design Thinking
- Lean Startup
- Business Model Canvas
- Customer Discovery

Recommended Mentor

- Innovation Mentor
- Business Development Mentor

If "Validation Stage" is Selected

Information Required

- Customer interviews completed
- Survey results
- Market research
- Competitor analysis
- Customer feedback
- Validation findings

Suggested Uploads

- Survey results
- Interview summaries
- Validation report

Assessments

- Market validation
- Customer discovery
- Problem–solution fit

Recommended Learning

- Market Validation
- Customer Research
- Value Proposition Design

Recommended Mentor

- Marketing Mentor

- Market Research Expert

If "Prototype / MVP Stage" is Selected

Information Required

- Product description
- MVP status
- Product features
- Number of users
- User feedback
- Product improvements planned

Suggested Uploads

- Product screenshots
- Prototype photos
- Demo video
- Product specifications

Assessments

- Product readiness
- User experience
- MVP evaluation

Recommended Learning

- Product Development
- Product Management
- UX Fundamentals

Recommended Mentor

- Product Mentor
- Technical Mentor

If "Early Startup Stage" is Selected

Information Required

- Date business started

- Customers acquired
- Paying customers
- Monthly revenue
- Team size
- Registration status

Suggested Uploads

- Business registration certificate
- Sales records
- Customer testimonials
- Financial records

Assessments

- Business model review
- Growth readiness
- Operations assessment

Recommended Learning

- Sales
- Marketing
- Financial Management
- Operations
- Business Growth

Recommended Mentor

- Growth Mentor
- Sales Mentor
- Finance Mentor

Section 2: Applicant Registration

Personal Information

Collect:

- First Name
- Last Name
- Preferred Name
- Gender

- Date of Birth
- Nationality
- National ID/Passport (optional)
- Email Address
- Phone Number
- Physical Address
- District
- Region
- Country

Demographics (Important for donor reporting)

Collect:

- Youth-owned business?
- Woman-owned business?
- Person with disability?
- Refugee/Displaced entrepreneur?
- Rural or Urban?
- Student entrepreneur?
- Graduate entrepreneur?

Section 3: Founder Profile

This evaluates the entrepreneur rather than the business.

Collect:

Educational Background

- Highest qualification
- Field of study
- Institution

Professional Experience

- Employment history
- Business experience
- Industry experience

Skills Assessment

Examples:

- Leadership
- Sales
- Marketing
- Finance
- Product Development
- Technology
- Operations

Rate confidence or experience level for each skill.

Section 4: Entrepreneurial Profile

Questions like:

- Why do you want to become an entrepreneur?
- Have you started a business before?
- Have you failed in business before?
- Have you participated in incubation before?
- What motivates you?

This helps mentors tailor their support.

Section 5: Business Stage Selection

Instead of simply asking the stage, make it interactive.

Example:

Select the stage that best describes your startup:

- Idea
- Validation
- Prototype/MVP
- Early Startup

Once selected, dynamically load the relevant fields.

Section 6: Startup Information

Collect:

Basic Information

- Startup Name
- Tagline
- Industry
- Sector
- Year Started
- Registration Status

Business Description

- What problem are you solving?
- Who experiences this problem?
- What is your solution?
- Why is your solution different?

Section 7: Stage-Based Dynamic Questions

If "Idea" is selected

Display:

Idea Validation

- Describe your idea
- What inspired the idea?
- What customer problem are you solving?
- Who is your ideal customer?
- Have you spoken to any potential customers?

Upload

- Concept note (optional)
- Sketches
- Research notes

If "Validation" is selected

Display:

Customer Discovery

- Number of customer interviews
- Surveys completed
- Market research conducted
- Competitors identified

Upload:

- Survey results
- Market research report

If "Prototype/MVP" is selected

Display:

Product Information

- Product developed?
- Prototype completed?
- MVP launched?
- Number of users
- Customer feedback

Upload:

- Screenshots
- Demo video
- Product photos

If "Early Startup" is selected

Display:

Business Performance

- Customers acquired
- Paying customers
- Monthly revenue
- Team size

Upload:

- Registration certificate
- Sales records
- Customer testimonials

Section 8: Team Information

Collect:

Founder

- Name
- Position
- Ownership percentage

Co-founders

- Name
- Role
- Skills

Team Members

- Position
- Responsibilities

Section 9: Business Needs Assessment

Ask applicants to prioritize areas where they need support.

Examples:

- Business Planning
- Product Development
- Marketing
- Branding
- Financial Management
- Accounting
- Legal Compliance
- Intellectual Property
- Investment Readiness
- Digital Marketing
- Leadership
- Sales
- Export Readiness

This information can later drive course recommendations and mentor matching.

Section 10: Learning Needs Assessment

Determine current knowledge levels.

Topics:

- Entrepreneurship
- Business Planning
- Marketing
- Finance
- Customer Validation
- Lean Startup
- Design Thinking

Rate each topic:

- Beginner
- Intermediate
- Advanced

Section 11: Mentor Matching Assessment

Collect preferences such as:

Preferred mentor expertise:

- Agriculture
- ICT
- Manufacturing
- Tourism
- Education
- Health

Preferred mentor characteristics:

- Language
- Gender (optional)
- Region (optional)
- Years of experience

Meeting preferences:

- Weekly
- Bi-weekly

- Monthly

Section 12: Incubation Goals

Ask:

What do you want to achieve by the end of the incubation program?

Examples:

- Validate my business idea
- Build an MVP
- Acquire first customers
- Register my business
- Develop a business plan
- Improve financial management
- Build a strong team
- Prepare for investment

Applicants can rank or prioritize these goals.

Section 13: Submission & Readiness Summary

Before submission, show a dashboard summarizing:

- ✓ Personal Profile Complete
- ✓ Startup Profile Complete
- ✓ Stage Assessment Complete
- ✓ Business Needs Assessment Complete
- ✓ Learning Needs Assessment Complete
- ✓ Documents Uploaded
- ✓ Mentor Preferences Selected
- ✓ Goals Defined

Also display:

Incubation Readiness Score (based on application completeness and diagnostics)

For example:

- Profile Completeness: 100%

- Business Information: 90%
- Documentation: 80%
- Readiness: 85%